

IAN SNIDER

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Robotist designing autonomous aerial vehicles for the field.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Nuclear Engineering - Robotics - University of California, Berkeley		Aug 2025 - present
B.S. Mechanical Engineering - Washington University in St. Louis	4.00/4.00	May 2025
B.A. Physics, Math minor - Truman State University	3.89/4.00	Dec 2024

EXPERIENCE

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory - Lab Affiliate, Berkeley, CA Aug 2025 - present

- Developed vision-based control for TARES, a hexacopter system steering a 10 m tether-suspended radiation detector
- Designed and implemented safety-critical software infrastructure for autonomous systems
- Architected a communication pipeline for GCS, transmitter, companion computer, and Cube Blue flight controller
- Executed autonomous flight tests at LBNL and Richmond Field Station under FAA Part 107
- Field-tested TARES at a radiological site in a demonstration for senior stakeholders

PUBLICATIONS

I. Snider, B. J. Quiter, E. Rofors, M. W. Mueller. "Vision-Based Control of a Tether-Suspended Aerial Radiation Sensing Payload." *arXiv preprint [arXiv:2609.27219](https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.27219)*, 2026. Submitted to IEEE ICRA 2027.

PROJECTS

Micro Mocap Low-Cost Mocap System for Small Drones - Developer Summer 2026

- Built a motion capture state estimation system from ~\$10 PS3 Eye cameras tracking IR LEDs
- Used it to fly an ~\$80 custom racing drone with stable maneuvering

Sniff Consensus Protocol for Noisy Multi-Agent Formations - Developer Fall 2025

- Designed a consensus protocol for multi-agent formations on random graphs with noisy communication
- Simulated Erdős-Rényi agent graphs and analyzed stability using ROS2 and Python

WashU Robotics MATE ROV & MARINER Projects - Mechanical Lead 2023 - 2025

- Designed and tested an autonomous underwater vehicle (AUV)
- Prototyped 1D hovering dive control using IMU and depth state estimation with a Kalman filter
- Built a chassis and buoyancy engine

Crazyflie 2.1 cascaded PID/PD Control System - ESE 4481 Course Project Spring 2025

- Designed a control system for a Crazyflie 2.1 quadcopter and achieved stable autonomous flight
- Simulated response and stability margins in Simulink and MATLAB; programmed the embedded controller in C

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory - Graduate Intern, Livermore, CA Jun 2025 - Dec 2025

- Developed CRISP, an HPC pipeline that automated compilation and benchmarking of ~3420 reactor simulations

Brookhaven National Laboratory - Student Researcher, Upton, NY Summers 2022 - 2024

- Developed BRR (Bayesian Resonance Reclassifier), a machine-learning classifier for nuclear data on HPC clusters

Truman State University - Student Astronomy Researcher, Kirksville, MO 2021 - 2022

- Calculated trajectories for ~3000 Starlink satellites to optimize telescope viewing plans and developed a GUI

SKILLS

- **Robotics:** ArduPilot, MAVLink, ROS2, OpenCV, PlatformIO
- **Programming:** C, C++, Python, Bash, Lua, MATLAB, LaTeX, Typst, Vimscript
- **Tools:** Simulink, SolidWorks, Slurm, Git, Linux

ACTIVITIES

WashU Robotics - Mechanical Lead

2020 - 2023

- Mechanical lead on the MATE ROV underwater robotics team (*see projects*)

WashU Climbing - Member

2023 - 2025

- Indoor and outdoor bouldering and lead climbing

Society of Physics Students - Demo Chair

2020 - 2023

- Developed 3 new physics demos, performed demos at meetings, and provided volunteer physics tutoring
- Wrote and proctored exams for 2022 & 2023 Science Olympiads (“Crave the Wave” and “Remote Sensing”)

TECHNICAL REPORTS AND ABSTRACTS

- [1] G. Nobre *et al.*, “Annual Report on NCSP Technical Support task in BNL during FY24,” 2024. doi: [10.2172/2474826](https://doi.org/10.2172/2474826).
- [2] I. Snider, G. Nobre, and D. Brown, “Resonance Capture Widths for the Bayesian Resonance Reclassifier,” in *APS Meeting Abstracts*, in APS Meeting Abstracts. Jan. 2023, p. DB3.074. [Online]. Available: <https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2023APS..HAWD03074S>
- [3] I. Snider, G. Nobre, D. Brown, and W. Fritsch, “Accuracy Correlation in Neutron Resonance Reclassification,” *Bulletin of the American Physical Society*, vol. 67, 2022.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory Student Research Conference. Lawrence Livermore National Lab B511, Livermore, CA, August 7th, 2025.
- Brookhaven National Laboratory Student Research Conference. Brookhaven National Lab Bldg. 488, Upton, NY, August 9th, 2024.
- American Physical Society - Division of Nuclear Physics and Japan Physical Society joint fall meeting. Hilton Waikoloa Village, The Big Island, HI, Nov 27-Dec 1, 2023.
- Brookhaven National Laboratory Student Research Conference. Brookhaven National Lab Bldg. 488, Upton, NY, August 10th, 2023.
- Truman State University Student Research Conference. Truman State University, Kirksville, MO, April 21st, 2023.
- American Physical Society - Division of Nuclear Physics fall meeting. Hyatt Regency Hotel, New Orleans, LA, October 29-31, 2022.
- Brookhaven National Laboratory Student Research Conference. Brookhaven National Lab Bldg. 488, Upton, NY, August 11th, 2022.

HONORS

Kenneth L. Jerina Prize for Outstanding Dual-Degree in Mechanical Engineering - WashU Engineering

April 2025

- Honored for academic achievements and engineering community contributions

Conference Experience for Undergraduates 2023 - APS DNP

September 2023

- Competitive research abstract award
- Invitation to present a research poster at the APS DNP Fall 2023 conference on The Big Island, HI

Conference Experience for Undergraduates 2022 - APS DNP

August 2022

- Competitive research abstract award
- Invitation to the poster presentation at the APS DNP Fall 2022 meeting in New Orleans, LA

Sigma Pi Sigma Honor Society - Truman State University

May 2022

- Recognized for service and academic scholarship in physics